

1.1 Creating Your Online Presence

Cyberspace is a vast sea of people... real people in the virtual world. Everyone is welcome, but who to trust is something no-one can say for sure. "Sheep in wolf's clothing" holds true more often than not here. The key to creating your online presence is ensuring you do not become one of these sheep: that you manage to declare and define honestly who you are.

There are many ways you can announce your arrival in cyberspace: e-mail, Instant Messenger IDs, your own Web site or blog, or by becoming part of a community or forum that matches your interests.

The challenge in becoming a part of a forum or community is finding one that interests you, and then slowly but steadily making your presence felt. Treat it like a new college you've just taken admission into. Naturally you are apprehensive because you don't know anybody. You don't know where to go... but you walk around and familiarise yourself with your surroundings and the campus.

Tip

Here are some things to remember:

First, while writing e-mails, never ever use abusive words. Remember how they are disgusting in real life too.

Do not lower your prestige on the Net.

Get a POP3 email account and write your mails offline. This will mean that you are not in a rush while writing. Take all the precautions you take while writing a real life letter. Greet people.

Remember to sign off with your name and be polite. You won't just hang up the phone without saying bye, would you?